Extra Exercises 23 – Everyday Workflows & Prompt Library

AI Training for Beginners

Self-study training: use AI/LLMs safely in everyday life

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https://github.com/mgunthner/AI-Training

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Extra Exercises 23 – Everyday Workflows & Prompt Library

To the cheatsheet: `01_cheatsheets/23_everyday_workflows`

Levels: ★ Getting started · ★★ Everyday · ★★★ Challenge **Rule:** Use only invented or anonymized data. All exercises work with any AI service and in the free plan. Suggested solutions are at the end. Only look after you're done.

Exercise 1 ★ – Set up a library

Scenario: You don't have a prompt library yet.

Task: Create a note file (e.g. "my_prompts.md") with this structure:

```
# My Prompt Library

## [Title]
- Purpose:
- Prompt:
- Example result: (anonymized)
- Note: (model, mode, date)
```

Enter a first prompt that worked well for you during the training.

Hint: The structure matters more than the quantity – every entry needs a title, purpose, and prompt.

Exercise 2 ★ – Choose a workflow

Scenario: The eight standard workflows from the cheatsheet (email, summary, learning plan, research, text revision, table help, decision preparation, meeting preparation).

Task: Pick the workflow that brings you the greatest benefit in everyday life and test it with invented data. Note: (a) What works well? (b) What do you adapt for yourself (length, tone, format)?

Hint: The best workflow is the one you really use again and again – not the most sophisticated one.

Exercise 3 ★★ – Professionalize a vague prompt

Scenario: This poorly working prompt: “Make something useful out of this text.”

Task: Turn it into a library-ready prompt for **text revision** with: goal, context, format, constraints, target audience. Test both versions with the same invented text and compare the results.

Hint: Use the template from cheatsheet 05: role/goal → context → task → format → limits.

Exercise 4 ★★ – Apply the mini quality check

Scenario: You have an AI text in front of you (e.g. a club newsletter based on invented data).

Task: Check it with the mini quality check: (1) **Is it correct?** – cross-check facts and numbers. (2) **Am I allowed to share it?** – data, rights, labeling (topic 22). (3) **Is it my style?** – sound, length, you/formal address. For each check, write your result and at least one correction.

Hint: The check deliberately takes only a few minutes – it’s a filter, not a final edit.

Exercise 5 ★★★ – When AI, when not?

Scenario: Eight situations from your everyday life (invented versions):

1. A thank-you email to a colleague after a difficult phase
2. A weekly report with a fixed format
3. A sympathy card to someone close to you
4. A summary of a 40-page report for yourself
5. Research preparation for vacation planning
6. A parenting question that concerns your parents
7. A tip calculator for a group bill
8. An apology letter to a customer after a mistake

Task: Decide for each situation: **AI yes** (which workflow?), **AI with strong own review** or **AI no** (why?). Justify briefly.

Hint: Criteria from the cheatsheet: reliability, relationship, verifiability, repeatability.

Transfer (optional)

Add one prompt to your library that you have actually needed in the last seven days. When did you last use it? What did it deliver?

Suggested solutions

Exercise 1: No fixed result. What matters: the file exists and the first entry is complete (title, purpose, prompt, example result). Anonymize names and sensitive details in the example.

Exercise 2: No fixed result. Typical adaptations: tone (informal/formal address), length ("maximum 3 sentences"), format (table vs. list), fixed additions ("Ask me follow-up questions before you start"). The added value comes from making the prompt good once and then using it repeatably.

Exercise 3: Model solution:

```
I revise technical texts for an audience with no prior knowledge.
Task: Simplify the following text. Keep all key points,
remove technical terms or explain them in brackets.
Format: Continuous prose, at most twice the number of paragraphs as
↪ the original.
Constraints: Don't change the meaning; list your changes at the end.
### Text
[your invented technical text]
```

The comparison typically shows: the vague version delivers arbitrary cuts or style breaks; the structured version is repeatable and verifiable (list of changes).

Exercise 4: Example: (1) Is it correct? – the date of the club festival was wrong (the AI changed it) → corrected. (2) Am I allowed to share it? – contains real members' names → replaced with "member A/B"; labeling "with AI assistance" added. (3) My style? – too formal, informal address missing → tone changed to "you", sentences shortened. The check catches errors that are often missed by reading alone, because the text sounds so smooth.

Exercise 5: Example assessment: (1) AI no or only minimal – the relationship counts, your own words matter more. (2) AI yes – fixed workflow, easy to verify. (3) AI no – personal, sensitive, no routine. (4) AI yes – summary workflow. (5) AI yes – research preparation (questions rather than results). (6) AI no – concerns other people, high consequences, not verifiable. (7) AI yes – simple arithmetic (or a calculator). (8) AI with strong review – usable for structure and tone, but content and responsibility stay with you.

Next: Cheatsheet 24 (Glossary & further learning), Test F (`03_tests/test_F_final`)

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